

teries and its only a one-time investment, but bad if you're outdoors, and run out of battery.

Performance

In the red spectrum deviation test, the Samsung Digimax 201 showed the least deviation—less than 10 per cent. Similarly, the BenQ DC2300 and Olympus C150 Camedia were the only cameras that were close to the Samsung 201's performance. The Logitech ClickSmart 510 performed the worst, with a deviation of greater than 25 per cent—essentially this means that if you shoot something that is red in colour, the photograph will show it as some other colour.

For the green spectrum deviation test, the Frontech Wonder CAM hit the bull's eye, with absolute zero deviation. The Samsung 210 showed its mettle again by recording a deviation of less than 5 per cent. Both the cameras from Vivitar performed pathetically, with a deviation of over 25 per cent. The Logitech 510 also yielded below average scores.

The Frontech Wonder CAM again showed excellent colour



TOYCAMS

Olympus C150	Samsung Digimax201	ViVitar *ViViCam 20	Vivitar ViViCam 3625
2048 x 1536	1600 x 1200	640x480	1600 x 1200
3.3x	2x	×	2x
✓	NA	×	NA
20 to 50	18.06 to 25	23 to 31	30.48 to 76.2
Auto; 4 modes	Auto; 4 modes	Automatic	Auto; 4 modes
✓	✓	×	✓
JPEG	JPEG	BMP	JPEG
6.7 x 11.2 x 4.0	9.39 x 6.6 x 4.06	9.8 x 3.55 x 6.02	NA
166	140	180	150
xD-Picture Card	SD/MMC	NA	SD card
32	8, internal	8, built-in	8, built-in
✓	✓	×	✓
AA	AA	AA	AA
9.2	11.3	0.4	0.4
5.25	6.75	0	2
4.13	6.63	1.75	1.97
2.5	2	1	1
1	1	1	1
8	12	6	6
8	8	NA	NA
13	13	13	13
8	8	6	8
21.08	26.6	3.15	5.37
2.9	2.7	2	3.2
9.9	11	*15.18	6.82
18+	18+	18+	18+
Komal International	Matrix Agency	Anirox Technologies Ltd	Anirox Technologies Ltd
022-22611274	022-23004061	033-228282372	033-228282372
022-22610219	022-23054631	033-22823086	033-22823086
indiaolympus@vsnl.net	matrixmk@vsnl.com	vivek@anirox.com	vivek@anirox.com
www.olympus.com	www.samsungcamera.com	www.vivitar.com	www.vivitar.com
9,995	9,995	3,500	9,500

Image size

Digital cameras come with 8 to 16 MB of built-in memory, and more often than not, you will find this far too less to store your photographs. The size of a high-quality image taken by a 3 megapixel camera will be around 2 to 2.5 MB. This permits you to click not more than eight high-quality images. However, choosing lower resolution brings down the file size to about 300 KB, and lets you store more images. Opt for a high resolution only when the image being captured is to be printed. Images that are to be stored on your PC will look lively even at a lower resolution.

Almost all cameras include the movie-capturing feature.

Some of them allow you to store video as much as the storage space allows, whereas the others restrict the video storage to a certain time limit. At an average, you can store just about 5 minutes of video footage at a resolution of 640 x 480. Hence, it isn't a very good idea to use the digital camera to make movies while you are on the move and away from your PC.

depth in the blue spectrum deviation test, with a deviation of less than 5 per cent. The Samsung 201 showed a deviation of more than 10 per cent here. The BenQ DC3410, the Logitech 510 and the Vivitar cameras all performed badly with deviations as high as 30 per cent. Such deviations are unacceptable and will lead to darker images, even in sufficiently lit indoor settings.

In the luminosity test, the Samsung reclaimed its crown, with negligible deviation. The Frontech Wonder CAM was the only camera that gave the Samsung some competition here, deviating only a per cent more. The cameras from Vivitar, Logitech and BenQ were a total disappointment, with deviations as high as 30 per cent.

Samsung also topped the specular effects and gradation test, with the BenQ twins coming in a close second. Overall, the Samsung Digimax 201 emerges as an outright winner, with excellent colour response, bright luminous images and a capability to catch all effects perfectly.

In the details test, the BenQ DC2300, Olympus C150 Camedia and Samsung Digimax 201 were the only cameras that were able to produce vibrant-looking photographs. The Creative PC-CAM 850, Logitech Clicksmart 510 and Vivitar ViViCam 20 performed the worst in this test—the pictures taken by them were simply too dark to earn any marks. Similarly, none of the cameras were able to reproduce Zone 2 of the details test, where we were looking for the text on the keyboard and the wrinkles on the doll's face. Only the Olympus C150, BenQ DC3410 and Samsung Digimax 210 managed to give decent output. In Zone 3 of the details test, we were expecting to see finer details, such as the pattern on the curtain in the background, but the results were disappointingly

poorer than Zone 2. Only

the BenQ DC 2300, Creative PC-CAM 850 and Samsung Digimax 201 gave decent results. The rest of the cameras couldn't detect finer details, especially the Logitech Clicksmart 510, and both the Vivitar models.



The Logitech Clicksmart 510 yielded dark photographs